



Gold hilt

Bronze blade

## ▲ SHORT SWORD

Date 1539–1075BCE

Origin Egypt

Length 32.3cm (12 $\frac{3}{4}$ in)

Leaf-shaped blade

Swords were probably introduced in the New Kingdom by invaders from the eastern Mediterranean, known as the “Sea Peoples”. This broad-bladed short sword is a display weapon that probably belonged to a member of the royal family.

Cutting edge



## ▲ SICKLE SWORD

Date 1200–1000BCE

Origin Egypt

Length 60cm (23 $\frac{1}{2}$ in)

The *khepesh*, or sickle-sword, came into use at the start of the New Kingdom. The curved blade had its cutting edge around the outside. The weapon was wielded more like an axe than a sword, and heavier specimens could be used to rip an opponent’s armour open, leaving him vulnerable to blade thrusts.

Wooden haft



## ► LION SHIELD

Date c.1325BCE

Origin Egypt

Width 54cm (21 $\frac{1}{4}$ in)

The soldier’s shield had a slightly convex shape. This protected the sides of his body and helped him to push against a densely packed line of opponents. This ornate display shield from the tomb of Tutankhamen shows the Pharaoh in the shape of a sphinx trampling his enemies.

Diamond-pattern chain decoration



## ▲ PHARAOH'S DAGGER

Date c.1325BCE

Origin Egypt

Length 31.9cm (12 $\frac{1}{2}$ in)

This dagger was found with the mummy of Tutankhamen and, with its golden blade and ornate golden sheath, was intended strictly for ceremonial use. The falcon on the hilt symbolized protection for the Pharaoh in the afterlife.

